

The FSCD forms, and what each one is for

Every form the program uses, what it does, how to fill it, and where it goes — with the three deadlines that catch families out

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown · September 2026

WHY THIS EXISTS

Ask FSCD for a list of its forms and you get fifteen. Section 11.1 of the policy manual names fifteen, and that is the list a parent can find.

The program's own internal operational procedures name twenty-eight.

That is not a conspiracy. It is what happens when a public list is maintained separately from the document staff work from day to day. But it means a parent asking "is there a form for this?" may be told no when there is one, and it means several of the most useful forms in the program — the agreement itself, the transition-to-adulthood set, the specialized services checklist — are not on the page families are pointed to.

This guide covers all of them.

Two things before you start.

Alberta's own page warns: "*Fillable PDF forms may not open properly on some mobile devices and web browsers.*" Open these in **Adobe Reader on a computer**. People lose a filled form this way and have to start again.

And nothing here is legal advice. At an appeal, or facing a cancellation, ask a lawyer, Legal Aid Alberta, or a community legal clinic.

THE THREE DEADLINES

If you read nothing else, read these.

45 days to appeal. This is in the Act itself, section 7(2) — not policy, not a guideline. It runs from the day you were notified of the decision.

Asking for a review does NOT pause those 45 days. The manual says so outright. People request a review, wait politely for an answer, and find the appeal window shut while they were waiting. **File the appeal first. Then ask for the review.** You can always withdraw an appeal. You cannot reopen a closed window.

Mediation DOES pause them — and that is statutory too, at section 7(4): "*the time for commencing an appeal is suspended until the conclusion or abandonment of the mediation.*" The manual adds that the count "*resumes the day after... the 45 days does not begin anew.*"

So the difference between review and mediation is not a matter of preference. One protects your clock and one does not.

A fourth, easily missed: 90 days from applying. If your supporting documents do not arrive within 90 calendar days, the file closes. Documents sent without an application are destroyed after 90 days.

PART 1 — GETTING IN AND STAYING IN

FSCD1621 — the FSCD agreement itself

What it is. The agreement between you and the program. Generated in the department's own system rather than downloaded, which is why it is not on the public forms list.

Why it matters. This is the document everything is measured against. Ask for your copy and keep it.

What most families do not know about the term. An agreement can run **up to three years** — or up to two years if you are waiting on a diagnosis. The manual says multi-year agreements "*will be used where possible to provide more predictability and continuity of services for families.*" If you are being handled as though this restarts every twelve months, it does not have to.

And the 60-day rule. FSCD staff must contact you **no less than 60 calendar days before your agreement expires**, by letter or email, asking to meet about a new one. If your agreement is running out and nobody has written to you, that letter is owed.

FSCD3593 — Individualized Family Support Plan (IFSP)

What it is. The plan setting out what was agreed and why.

When it applies — and when it does not. An IFSP is required for every family receiving **Child-Focused Services**. It is **not** required for a Family Support Services agreement, multi-year or otherwise. If you are on FSS and are being asked for an IFSP, the manual does not require one of you.

How to fill it. You build it with your caseworker. What you bring is detail. Write down what a bad day looks like in specifics — the hours, the behaviours, the toll. Vague needs produce vague plans.

The two-stage door most people never find

You do not have to wait for the full assessment to get anything.

The manual: "*FSCD may enter into an FSS Agreement with families who have had their program eligibility confirmed, prior to having a Family/Child Assessment of Needs (FCAON) completed for Child focused services (if needed).*"

Family Support Services can start once eligibility is confirmed. That covers counselling, clothing and footwear, medical appointment supports, **respite**, and **Triple P** parenting support. The big assessment is what unlocks Child-Focused Services later.

If you are eligible and being told nothing happens until the assessment, ask about an FSS agreement by name.

FSCD3594 — Verification of On or Off Reserve Status for Funding Purposes

What it is. Establishes which government funds the services.

Why it matters. It is an administrative question about funding, not a question about whether your child qualifies. Ask for it to be dealt with in parallel rather than as a gate.

AAS13391 — Consent to Release Information

What it is. Your written permission for FSCD to share your file, or to talk to someone acting for you.

How to fill it. Name the person **and the limits**. Consent can be narrow — "this worker, this file, until this date" — rather than an open door. This is the form that lets somebody else make the phone call when you cannot face making it, and it is the one people sign too broadly.

PART 2 — MONEY, CLAIMS AND RECEIPTS

FSCD1845 — Statement of Expense · FSCD0003 — Record of Services Provided

What they are. The paper claim for money you have already spent, and the record a service provider completes confirming hours and services delivered.

How claims run. Most reimbursement goes through the **Online Claims Reimbursement portal** at ocr.alberta.ca; the paper form is the fallback. **You must validate that services were received before an agency's invoice is paid.**

The rule that shapes your whole filing system: keep original receipts and records for seven years.

If you cannot afford to pay first and be reimbursed later

There is a process for this and almost nobody knows it exists.

The operational procedures say that where "*finances are a barrier for a family in the reimbursement process*," the caseworker will discuss alternative payments, complete a **Post and Pre-Payment Billing Arrangement Decision-Guide** with their supervisor, and — if the criteria are met — seek **manager approval**.

So the answer to "I cannot float this until reimbursement" is not "that is how it works." **It is a named internal process with a form and an approval path.** Ask for it by name.

What FSCD pays per hour — said plainly

Nobody can tell you, and that is a finding rather than a gap.

The rate is not in the policy manual. It is not in the 176 pages of internal operational procedures either — those leave it blank for the caseworker to fill in. The respite clause reads "*not to exceed \$ (rate) per*". There are **549 fill-in placeholders** in that document and **thirteen dollar figures in total**, and six of the thirteen are fines for privacy offences.

So when a provider quotes you a price and says FSCD covers this much and you pay the rest, there is no published figure you can check it against.

What you can do: ask the provider **in writing, before the first session**, whether they bill FSCD directly at the FSCD rate and whether any balance comes to you. Keep the answer.

On that balance — we looked. The complete operational procedures were searched for: top-up, balance, difference in cost, exceeds the rate, above the rate, parent pays, additional cost to the family, private pay, out of pocket, invoice, charge, surcharge, co-pay, shortfall, and pay the difference. **No provision permits it and no provision prohibits it.** The practice is simply unaddressed.

PART 3 — MEDICAL, DENTAL AND HARDSHIP

FSCD12859 — Confirmation of Medical Appointment or Hospital Stay

What it is. Proof the appointment or admission happened, for claiming travel, parking, meals and accommodation.

How to fill it. The clinic or hospital completes their part. **Ask at the desk on the day** — chasing it weeks later is far harder.

What it unlocks, and the caps. Mileage at **\$0.12 per kilometre**. Parking to **\$10 a day**. For a day trip of at least 8 hours but not overnight: **\$5 a day meals for the child, \$8 for one adult**. Overnight: accommodation to **\$85 a night**, meals to **\$10 a day** for the child and **\$15** for one adult, or **\$100 a week** for groceries. A second person where required: **\$15 a day or \$50 a week**.

Note the day-trip and overnight rates are different. Quoting the overnight figures for a day trip overstates them by half.

FSCD0056 — Request for Dental and Orthodontic Treatment Assistance

What it is. Help with dental or orthodontic work related to your child's disability.

How it works in practice — this is not what most people assume. The treatment is funded "according to fee schedules in a Memorandum of Understanding" with Alberta Health. **Your provider forwards the invoice to a dental review committee, and that committee pays the provider directly.** The service is then entered in your agreement **at \$0**, because no money passes through you.

The deadline nobody mentions: once approved, the treatment must be used within one year of the date of approval. Approval is not open-ended.

The threshold. Where you have no dental plan, the program engages on costs exceeding **\$250 a year**.

If you disagree with the committee. There is a concern resolution route, and your caseworker is required to explain it.

FSCD12556 — Medical Benefits Significant Financial Hardship Calculation

What it is. The worksheet deciding whether a medical cost counts as significant financial hardship.

The threshold, from the Regulation. Medical benefits are considered where costs exceed **2% of the combined net income of the child's parents**, taken from **line 23600** of the previous year's returns.

Be ready for the arithmetic to feel cold. The operational procedures deduct a deemed average cost of feeding a child — **\$75 a month** for ages 0 to 6, **\$118** for 7 to 12, **\$153** for 13 to 17 — on the reasoning that you would be feeding the child anyway.

Why fill it in anyway. It turns "we cannot afford it" from a statement into an assessment. An assessment can be appealed. A conversation cannot.

PART 4 — ASSESSMENT AND SPECIALIZED SERVICES

FSCD13335 — Child's Daily Routine Schedule

This is the most under-used form in the program. Take it seriously.

What it is. An hour-by-hour picture of your child's day.

How to fill it. Record the real day, **including the night**. The wakings. The time a single transition takes. The two-person tasks. The hours nobody sees. Do it across a full week, not a good day.

Why it matters more than it looks. The Regulation lists **fifteen factors the director and an appeal committee must consider** — and this form is how several of them get evidenced. Among them: **the impact the child's disability has on the family; the physical and emotional well-being of the guardians and others living in the same home; the needs of the child's siblings; the availability of people other than the guardians to help; and the geographic location of your home community.**

A daily routine schedule that records the nights, the two-person tasks, the sibling impact and the distance to services is evidence going straight to those factors. It is also the most persuasive document at an appeal, because it is specific, it is yours, and nobody can argue you were not there.

The specialized services set — FSCD12344, FSCD12348, FSCD12349, FSCD13336, FSCD12081

FSCD12344 is your checklist. **FSCD12348** is the coversheet. **FSCD12349** carries the multi-disciplinary team's recommendations. **FSCD13336** is the worker's own documentation checklist. **FSCD12081** is the decision letter.

What the gate requires. A severe disability producing significant limitations in **two or more** of behaviour, communication and socialization, cognitive abilities, physical and motor development, and self-help and adaptive functioning — plus a multi-disciplinary team assessment finding a **critical need**, an individualized plan, and a finding that other programs are not appropriate or sufficient.

Ask for a copy of the completed FSCD12349. It is the clinical case for your own child in the clinicians' own words, and it is the document that carries weight in any later dispute.

One deadline. Where specialized services start, FSCD staff must receive the Individualized Service Plan within **90 calendar days** of services commencing.

FSCD0467 — Service Provider's Program Plan

What it is. The provider's own plan for what they will deliver.

Why ask for it. It is where "we will work on communication" becomes a specific, checkable commitment.

FSCD12355 — Exceptional Consideration Authorization

What it is. The route to something outside the normal limits, authorised by a manager.

Why it matters. Most families never hear this form exists. It is the written acknowledgement that published maximums are not the only answer. **If you are told something is not possible, it is fair to ask whether an exceptional consideration has been considered — and to ask for the answer in writing.**

PART 5 — WHEN THEY SAY NO

FSCD3561 — Request for Review

30 calendar days from the notice of the decision. Internal, by managers who were not involved.

Read the deadlines page again before you use this one. A review does not stop your appeal clock.

AAS13358 — Notice of Appeal

45 days. To the Citizen's Appeal Panel — an arm's-length panel, not FSCD staff.

Three things families learn too late:

- **Your other services continue while you appeal.** The manual: *"Other agreed upon FSCD services will continue to be provided while a parent or guardian is appealing a decision."*
- **Your right to bring someone is statutory**, not a courtesy. Act s.9(2): *"An appellant may be represented at a hearing of an appeal by a lawyer or by any other person."* Bring someone.
- **Hearings are in English.** Interpreters are arranged, but only if you ask.

And the one that ends appeals: if you cannot be reached when the hearing is scheduled, it may go ahead without you and your right to appeal ends. Tell them immediately if your phone, email or address changes.

A note on where to send it. The Act says the notice is served **on the director**, who must then pass it to a panel chair within 10 days. The government's guidance tells you to file with the **Appeals Secretariat**. These are almost certainly the same journey described from two ends — but with a 45-day statutory clock running, **send it both ways on the same day and keep proof of both.**

PDDFSCD10925 — Request for Mediation

30 calendar days. A neutral third party helps you and the program reach something you both accept. The mediator does not decide anything.

Mediation reaches further than appeal does. The Act allows mediation of "*any decision made by the director under this Act*" — broader than the decisions that can be appealed.

And it stops your clock. See the deadlines page.

If the process itself was unfair

Two routes: a lawyer, for legal remedies — or the **Office of the Alberta Ombudsman**, which looks at whether a public body treated you fairly in *how* it decided, rather than at whether the decision was right. The Ombudsman is free.

PART 6 — TURNING 18

Planning is supposed to start at **16**, for every youth, not on request. These are the forms that carry it:

- **FSCD0013** — Transition to Adulthood Pathway
- **FSCD0005** — Transition to Adulthood Plan (TAP)
- **FSCD0006** — Transition Planning Checklist
- **FSCD0007** — Transition to Adulthood Record Keeping Checklist
- **FSCD0011** and **FSCD0012** — tip sheets on integrated transition planning and on involving the youth in their own case conference

None of these six are on the public forms list. All six are named in the operational procedures.

The TAP replaces the IFSP at 16 and is kept on the file. FSCD leads it, but it is meant to pull in adult programs, Education and Health so supports are in place **when the youth turns 18** — not started then.

If your child is 16 and nobody has raised transition planning, ask for it by name. It is the expectation, not a favour.

THE LAST PAGE — WHERE EVERYTHING GOES

Before you send anything. Photocopy or scan every page, including signatures. Note the date you sent it and how. Use a method that produces a receipt for anything carrying a deadline. Keep originals seven years.

What	Where it goes
New application	Online, or the Alberta Supports Contact Centre
Alberta Supports Contact Centre	1-877-644-9992 · Edmonton 780-644-9992
Claims and reimbursement	ocr.alberta.ca — the Online Claims Reimbursement portal

What	Where it goes
Agreement, IFSP, assessments, daily routine, specialized services set, exceptional consideration, hardship, transition forms	Your FSCD caseworker , at the office holding your file
FSCD0056 dental	Your provider sends it to the dental review committee , which pays the provider directly
FSCD3561 Request for Review	The FSCD office that made the decision
PDDFSCD10925 Mediation	Arranged through your FSCD worker; sent to the office holding the file, or the address on the decision letter
AAS13358 Notice of Appeal	The Appeals Secretariat — not FSCD. And to the director as well; see Part 5

Appeals Secretariat. Phone **780-427-2709** · toll free in Alberta dial **310-0000** first, then the number · fax **780-422-1088** · email **alss.appeals@gov.ab.ca** · offices in Edmonton (main), Calgary, Red Deer and Lethbridge.

Every deadline on one line

Clock	Length	Runs from
Supporting documents after applying	90 calendar days	The application being received
Reopening a closed file without reapplying	under 180 days	The date of closure
Request for Review	30 calendar days	Notice of the decision
Mediation request	30 calendar days	Notice of the decision
Notice of Appeal	45 days	Being notified of the decision. A review does not pause it. Mediation does.
Individualized Service Plan	90 calendar days	Specialized services commencing
Approved dental treatment must be used	1 year	The date of approval
FSCD must contact you before your agreement expires	60 calendar days	The expiry date
Keep receipts	7 years	—

If it has gone wrong

Office of the Alberta Ombudsman — process fairness. Free. **Advocate for Persons with Disabilities** — support through the process. **Legal Aid Alberta or a community legal clinic** — legal advice.

Compiled from the Family Support for Children with Disabilities Act (current to June 17, 2021), the FSCD Regulation AR 140/2004 (current to June 25, 2025), the FSCD Policy and Procedures Manual, and the FSCD Internal Operational Procedures dated January 27, 2025 — all read directly. Not legal advice.

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